

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Are medical interventions more likely with an induction? If your labor is induced, the chance that you will need an assisted delivery with [forceps](#) or [vacuum](#) or a cesarean is increased. This is even more likely if you are having your first baby, if the cervix is unfavorable, or if you're being induced relatively early in your pregnancy. The reason for these medical interventions is usually that the labor is proceeding too slowly, or that it cannot be started at all, despite all of the steps taken. Also, concerns about the baby's well-being during the induction process can sometimes lead to intervention.

Is induction of labor more painful than a spontaneous labor? Some women find that they experience strong contractions very quickly after an induction. Since they haven't been able to build up gradually to more painful contractions, they may be less able to tolerate the pain, which can result in an increased need for stronger types of pain relief such as an epidural.